Were the 14 July 1942 resolutions forming the backdrop of the ‘Quit India’ movement to be drafted for the present context, they would read remarkably similar:

1. An immediate end to communally divisive politics.
2. Twenty-first-century India’s declaration of commitment to defend itself from all types of fascism and crony capitalism.
3. After the defeat of the communal forces, to form governments that will provide a healing touch and bring back the rule of law and the primacy of the Constitution.
4. A civil movement for mutual respect for diversity, federalism and democracy.

If these resolutions propelled the ‘Jodo’ Yatra, the nature of the Yatra would have been significantly different from other yatras organized in recent decades. And most certainly it would be a complete antithesis of the Rath Yatra that opened up the path to endless communal discord and majority nationalism. Sensing the immense possibilities that the Jodo Yatra brought to our collective conscience, civil society organizations announced their endorsement and participation in the Yatra during a conclave in Delhi on 22 August. The spirit of the conclave was truly democratic. Tough questions were posed by the participants to Rahul Gandhi and Digvijaya Singh, and frank answers were provided by them. Most of the civil society members came from an anti-Congress background. Yet, the strength of the ‘Jodo’ idea was such that they, too, felt that the moment had come for the people of India to join hands with political parties for a united fight against hatred, fascism and divisive forces. In the joint statement that was subsequently issued by civil society organizations, it was unequivocably stated, ‘We are distressed by the ruling party’s abuse of the state agencies for stifling and intimating dissent and obscuring truth. We are equally alarmed by the active promotion of division, hatred and violence by the ruling party and its now-normalized fringe groups. This regime’s sheer indifference to the well-being of the vast majority of Indians, its manifest incompetence in handling crisis